

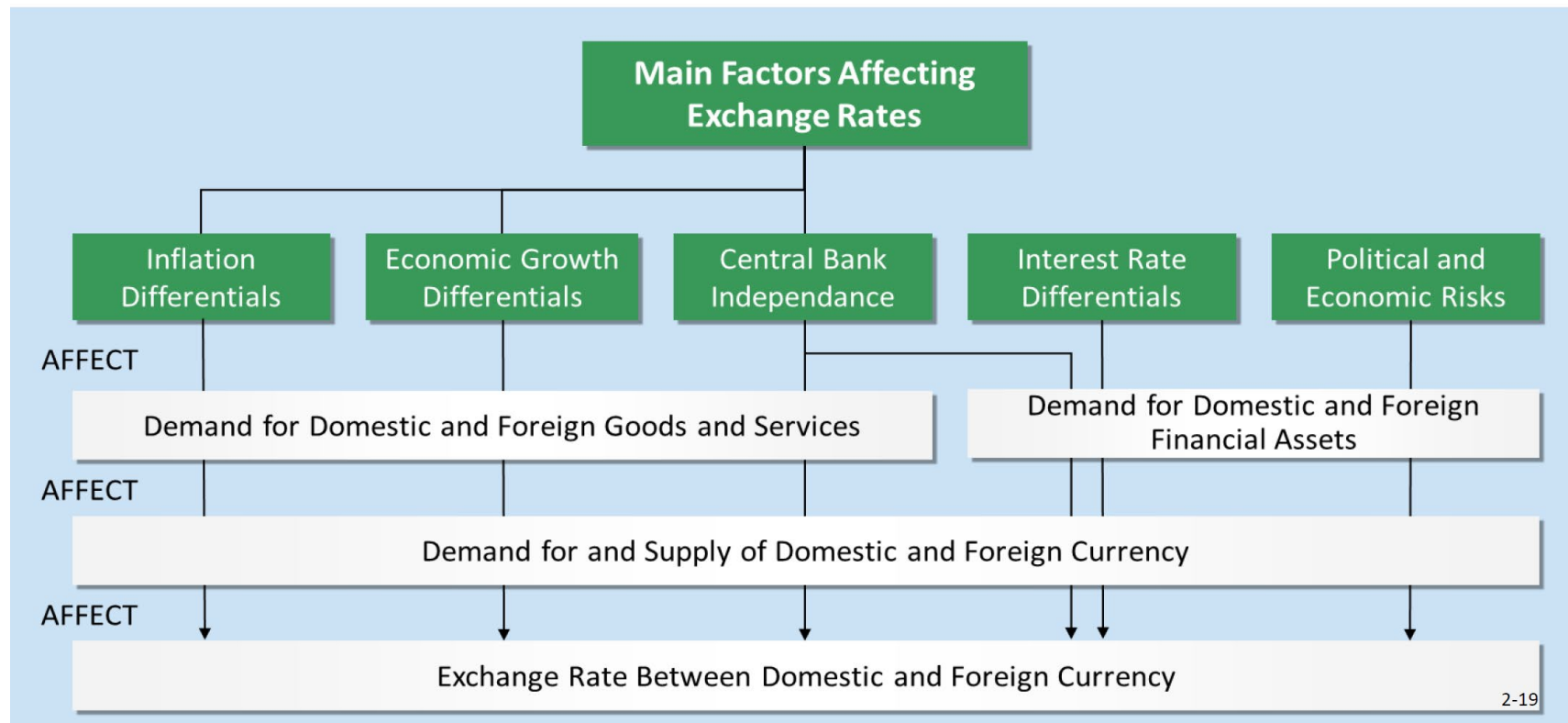
Chapter 4: Extra proofs and comments—Part 2

NOTE:

1. These notes do not contain any new examinable material.
2. They contain some elaborations on the lecture notes, with extra explanations and examples, and even a few mathematical derivations—which are not examinable.
3. I will refer to them in class.
4. However, students can ignore them if they don't find them useful.

Slide 4-9: Recall Ch. 2, Slide 2-19:

How the Main Factors Affect Exchange Rates



Slide 4-15 (Relative PPP)

From Absolute PPP (slide 4-11), we saw that the following should hold:

$$P_h = e_0 P_f \text{ so that } e_0 = \frac{P_h}{P_f}.$$

If this holds at date 0 and continues to hold, then
at date t , we would expect

$$e_t = \frac{P_h(1+i_h)^t}{P_f(1+i_f)^t} = \frac{P_h}{P_f} \times \frac{(1+i_h)^t}{(1+i_f)^t} = e_0 \times \frac{(1+i_h)^t}{(1+i_f)^t}.$$

Aside: a math result:

Suppose $\frac{1+x}{1+y} = 1+a$ and $a \times y \approx 0$. Then, cross-multiplying gives

$$1+x = (1+a)(1+y) = 1+a+y+a \times y \approx 1+a+y.$$

So, $a \approx x-y$. But $a = \frac{1+x}{1+y} - 1$ by assumption, which gives

$$\frac{1+x}{1+y} - 1 \approx x-y.$$

Slide 4-18: For $t = 1$,

$$\frac{e_t - e_0}{e_0} = \frac{1}{e_0} (e_t - e_0) = \frac{1}{e_0} \left(e_0 \times \frac{(1+i_h)}{(1+i_f)} - e_0 \right) = \frac{(1+i_h)}{(1+i_f)} - 1 \approx i_h - i_f.$$

Slide 4-24: Real Rate of Interest, Nominal Rate of Interest, and Inflation

Example: A can of Coke costs $p_0 = \$2.00$ at time 0, and with inflation it is expected to cost $\tilde{p}_1 = \$2.10$ in one year, i.e., *the inflation rate is*

$$i = \frac{\tilde{p}_1 - p_0}{p_0} = 5\%.$$

The current 1-year *nominal interest rate* is $r = 9\%$. If you buy 100 Cokes today, you will pay \$200. If you invest the \$200 for one year, you will have \$218 and since Coke will cost \$2.10 per can, you can buy $218/2.10 = 103.81$ cans. So, we say that the *real* interest rate is $a = 3.81\%$; the formula is

$$1 + a = \frac{1 + r}{1 + i}. \text{ Also, on slide 4-26, we write this as } (1 + r) = (1 + a)(1 + i).$$

This is the Fisher Effect.

From our maths result, $a = \frac{1+r}{1+i} - 1 \approx r - i$.

Slide 27

Suppose real returns are equal across countries: $a_h = a_f$.

This means that

$$\frac{1+r_h}{1+i_h} = 1 + a_h = 1 + a_f = \frac{1+r_f}{1+i_f}.$$

Or, rearranging:

$$\frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f} = \frac{1+i_h}{1+i_f}.$$

NOTE: on slide 4-15, Relative PPP implied:

$$e_1 = e_0 \times \frac{1+i_h}{1+i_f}.$$

By the above equality, we have,

$$e_1 = e_0 \times \frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f}.$$

Slide 4-29

From the equation $\frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f} = \frac{1+i_h}{1+i_f}$ (on slide 4-27, which assumes real

returns are equal across countries) and our maths result,

$$r_h - r_f \approx \frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f} - 1 = \frac{1+i_h}{1+i_f} - 1 \approx i_h - i_f.$$

EXTRA COMMENTS on Slide 4-29: From Slide 4-27,

$$\frac{1+r_h}{1+i_h} = 1+a_h \approx 1+a_f = \frac{1+r_f}{1+i_f}. \text{ Subtract 1 from each term:}$$

$$r_h - i_h \approx \frac{1+r_h}{1+i_h} - 1 = a_h \approx a_f = \frac{1+r_f}{1+i_f} - 1 \approx r_f - i_f.$$

At point D: $r_h - r_f = -3$; $i_h - i_f = -2$, or

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} r_h + 3 = r_f \\ i_h + 2 = i_f \end{array} \right\} \text{ Subtracting : } r_h - i_h + 1 = r_f - i_f.$$

So, the foreign country has a *higher* real interest rate and so funds should flow from the home country to the foreign country.

Slide 4-35

Let's show that $\bar{e}_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1+r_h)^t}{(1+r_f)^t}$.

From Relative PPP (slide 4-15), $e_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1+i_h)^t}{(1+i_f)^t}$.

Assuming real interest rates are equal across countries (slide 4-27):

$$\frac{(1+r_h)}{(1+r_f)} = \frac{(1+i_h)}{(1+i_f)}.$$

This implies that $e_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1+r_h)^t}{(1+r_f)^t}$, but we write it with $\bar{e}_t$:

$\bar{e}_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1+r_h)^t}{(1+r_f)^t}$, which is IFE. (This will relate to *forward prices*, too.)

Slide 4-36 (word processing glitch)

Example: $r_{UK} = 8\%$, $r_{US} = 6\%$, $e_0 = \text{USD } 1.6545 / \text{GBP}$.

$$\bar{e}_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1+r_h)^t}{(1+r_f)^t} = e_0 \times \frac{(1+r_{US})^t}{(1+r_{UK})^t} = 1.6545 \times \frac{1.06}{1.08} = 1.6239 < e_0.$$

Slide 4-37

Here, we want to show that $\frac{\bar{e}_t - e_0}{e_0} \approx r_h - r_f$. This is very similar to what we

saw for PPP: $\frac{e_t - e_0}{e_0} \approx i_h - i_f$. For $t = 1$,

$$\frac{\bar{e}_t - e_0}{e_0} = \frac{1}{e_0} (\bar{e}_t - e_0) = \frac{1}{e_0} \left(e_0 \times \frac{(1 + r_h)}{(1 + r_f)} - e_0 \right) = \frac{(1 + r_h)}{(1 + r_f)} - 1 \approx r_h - r_f,$$

where the last step is our maths result, again.

EXTRA COMMENT: Slide 4-38

At point F,

$$\frac{\bar{e}_t - e_0}{e_0} = 3\% \text{ and } r_h - r_f = 2\%.$$

If we invest in the home country we get a 2% higher return.

If we buy the foreign currency and invest, we get a lower return, but we get a 3% return on the currency.

So, invest in the foreign currency.

Slide 4-39

A **forward exchange contract** is a private agreement to buy or sell a specified amount of foreign currency at a fixed rate on a future date, allowing firms to lock in exchange rates and eliminate FX risk. These contracts trade **over-the-counter**, mainly through banks, and are widely used by corporates and financial institutions for hedging rather than speculation.

In general, futures are traded on exchanges, but forwards are over-the-counter.

One of the key differences between forwards and futures is that futures are “marked to market”.

Slide 4-44

We're investing at (date $t = 0$) USD 1 million for 3 months (date t).

Spot rate is $e_0 = \text{EUR } 0.74000 / \text{USD}$. Here, EUR is the home currency!

3-month forward rate is

$$f_3 = \text{EUR } 0.73637 / \text{USD} = \text{price of USD in terms of EUR.}$$

US interest rate is 8% per year, or $r_{US} = 2\%$ per 3-month period.

European interest rate is 6% per year or $r_{EUR} = 1.5\%$ per 3-month period.

Alternative investment: Invest in US: future value is

$$\text{USD } 1 \text{ million} \times (1 + r_{US}) = \text{USD } 1,020,000.$$

1. Convert USD 1,000,000 to EUR to Invest in Europe:

$$\text{Euros} = 1,000,000 \times e_0 = \text{EUR } 740,000 \text{ (at date 0).}$$

2. Invest at 6% or $r_{Eur} = 1.5\%$ per 3-month period

$$\text{Future value is EUR } 740,000 \times (1 + r_{EUR}) = \text{EUR } 751,100.$$

3. Convert to USD at forward rate: $\frac{751,100}{f_3} = \frac{751,100}{0.73637} = \text{USD } 1,020,004.$

Summary of cashflow calculations:

$$\frac{1,000,000 \times e_0 \times (1 + r_{EUR})}{f_3} = \text{USD } 1,020,004$$

$$1,000,000(1 + r_{US}) = 1,020,000 \approx 1,020,004.$$

In general (ignoring the 1,000,000), we must have (ignoring the size of the initial cash-flow):

$$\frac{e_0 \times (1 + r_{EUR})}{f_3} = (1 + r_{US}), \text{ or}$$

$$f_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1 + r_{EUR})^t}{(1 + r_{US})^t} = \text{forward price of USD in terms of EUR.}$$

In general: $f_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1 + r_h)^t}{(1 + r_f)^t}$. This is **Interest Rate Parity (IRP)**.

Compare to IFE: $\bar{e}_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1 + r_h)^t}{(1 + r_f)^t}$.

Slide 4-50

Let's re-write the no-arbitrage condition as: $f_t \times (1 + r_f)^t = e_0 \times (1 + r_h)^t$.

Now let's assume this *doesn't* hold. Suppose

$$f_t \times (1 + r_f)^t > e_0 \times (1 + r_h)^t$$

(high side) (low side)

Intuition: to take advantage of this arbitrage opportunity, date $t = 0$:

e_0 is on the “low side”, so buy the foreign currency;

f_t is on the “high side” so sell (short) the futures;

r_h is on the “low side”, so *borrow* in the domestic market;

r_f is on the “high side”, so *invest* in the foreign market.

(Can you do the $f_t \times (1 + r_f)^t < e_0 \times (1 + r_h)^t$ case on your own?)

Slide 4-50 (cont'd)

In this case, $r_h = 7\%$, $e_0 = \text{USD } 1.95/\text{GBP}$, $r_f = 12\%$, $f_1 = \text{USD } 1.87/\text{GBP}$, and $t = 1$.

$$f_1 = 1.87 > 1.95 \times \frac{(1 + 0.07)}{(1 + 0.12)} = 1.8629, \text{ so } f_t \times (1 + r_f)^t > e_0 \times (1 + r_h)^t.$$

Here are the transactions. Note that #forwards = $(1.12) \times 1,000,000 / 1.95$

Date $t = 0$	Date $t = 1$
Borrow \$1,000,000 at 7%	Pay \$1,070,000
Buy 1,000,000/1.95 GBP	
Invest GBP 512,820.51 at 12%	Receive GBP 512,820.51 $\times$ (1.12)
	Sell GBP 574,385.97 at USD 1.87/ GBP
	= Receive \$1,074,051.28
Sell GBP 574,385.97 forwards	

Note: (a) $1,000,000 / 1.95 = 512,820.51$; (b) $512,820.51 \times (1.12) = 574,385.97$; and (c) $574,385.97 \times 1.87 = 1,074,051.28$.

Slide 4-50 (cont'd) [READ ON YOUR OWN]

Let's repeat the previous example, except assume $f_1 = \text{USD } 1.85 / \text{GBP}$.

In this case,

$$f_1 = 1.85 < 1.95 \times \frac{(1 + 0.07)}{(1 + 0.12)} = 1.8629, \text{ so } f_t \times (1 + r_f)^t < e_0 \times (1 + r_h)^t.$$

Here are the transactions:

Date $t = 0$	Date $t = 1$
Borrow GBP 512,820.51 at 12%	Pay GBP 512,820.51 $\times$ (1.12)
Sell 512,820.51 GBP for \$1M.	
Invest \$1,000,000 at 7%	Receive \$1,070,000
	Buy GBP 574,385.97 at USD 1.85 / GBP
	= Pay \$1,062,614.04
Buy GBP 574,385.97 forwards	

Note: (a) $1,000,000 / 1.95 = 512,820.51$; (b) $512,820.51 \times (1.12) = 574,385.97$; and (c) $574,385.97 \times 1.85 = 1,062,614.04$.

Slide 4-60

The equation for e_5 is just the equation for the forward rate that we derived based on Slide 4-44.

First, let's re-write the numbers using general notation:

5-year USD interest rate is $6\% = r_{US}$; and 5-years = t .

5-year EUR interest rate is $5\% = r_{EUR}$.

Current exchange rate is USD 0.90/EUR = e_0 .

Value of EUR in 5 years = $e_t = f_t$.

Here is the equation on Slide 4-60:

$$\frac{(1.05)^5 \times e_5}{0.90} = (1.06)^5, \text{ which becomes } \frac{(1 + r_{EUR})^t \times f_t}{e_0} = (1 + r_{US})^t.$$

Solving for the forward rate gives Interest Rate Parity (IRP):

$$f_t = e_0 \times \frac{(1 + r_{US})^t}{(1 + r_{EUR})^t} = \text{forward price of EUR in terms of USD.}$$

EXTRA COMMENT: Slides 4-52 and 4-53

The vertical axis says

Interest differential in favour of home country, i.e., $r_h - r_f \approx \frac{1 + r_h}{1 + r_f} - 1$;

The horizontal axis says

“Forward premium (+) or discount (−) on foreign currency (%)”

The forward premium is $\frac{f - e_0}{e_0}$.

At Point G, $r_h - r_f \approx \frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f} - 1 = 2\%$, while $\frac{f - e_0}{e_0} = 3\%$, so

$$\frac{f - e_0}{e_0} > \frac{1+r_h}{1+r_f} - 1.$$

After some algebra, we see that

$$f - e_0 > e_0 \frac{(1+r_h)}{(1+r_f)} - e_0, \text{ or } f > e_0 \frac{(1+r_h)}{(1+r_f)}.$$

Here, you buy the foreign currency and sell the forward (so that the exchange rate risk is covered.) With the numbers given on slide 4-52, we will make an extra 1% annually.

Slides 4-52 and 4-53 (cont'd)

At Point H, $r_h - r_f \approx \frac{1 + r_h}{1 + r_f} - 1 = 4\%$, while $\frac{f - e_0}{e_0} = 3\%$, so

$$f < e_0 \frac{(1 + r_h)}{(1 + r_f)}.$$

Here, you sell the foreign currency and buy the forward (so that the exchange rate risk is covered.) With the numbers given on slide 4-52, we will again make an extra 1% annually.